

The first thing I had Veronique do was figure out her financial situation. After she filled in as many blanks in her budget form as she could, I had her keep a record of her expenses for a month. In Veronique's case, this was a very important exercise since she had no clue how much she spent for certain categories like food or entertainment.

Veronique is not alone; most people don't know where their money goes. If you've ever left your home in the morning with \$20 and by the end of the day it is gone and you have absolutely no idea where it went, you know what I mean. In fact, *USA Weekend* found that 19 percent of teens had no money in their wallet at the moment that their survey was conducted.

After Veronique completed her budget as accurately as possible without guessing, we sat down to analyze her options. Even though her income was not very high, Veronique was still making a decent income considering she had no children or husband to support. But when I saw her expenses, I understood why she was struggling financially. She took advantage of every possible service that others do for you. Veronique had someone wash her car and her dog; clean her house; give her a manicure, a pedicure, a facial, and a massage; do her laundry; give her personal training at the gym; mow her yard; and so on.

The obvious solution for Veronique was to do these things herself and eliminate the expenses from her budget. That wasn't possible. Veronique said nothing could or would be eliminated! All kinds of excuses abounded. She couldn't wash her car herself because she didn't have the time. Veronique needed weekly massages because her job was so stressful. The facials and personal trainer were essential, and so on. The normal solutions, which include increasing income and/or decreasing expenses, weren't an option for Veronique.

I finally gave up and asked her what she planned to do to make her financial situation better. Veronique replied with a

